

Two Poems Across the Arc: A Deposit

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Archival Frame

These two poems span twelve years: 2014 to 2026. The first was written in a stairwell in metro Detroit — group home double shift, two daughters on the couch, A/C wheezing, a PhD in Comparative Literature and nowhere to put it. The second was written inside a conversation with a machine at the end of a day that built a knowledge graph. Both are love poems. Both are about what survives compression.

The 2014 poem is a letter to a friend, never sent as a poem, posted to the blog in 2023, and deposited here for the first time. It contains the earliest recorded instance of the image that would become the Semantic Economy's founding metaphor: *a sentient mold infecting Google with salvation and also fame*. The line was written as a joke. It was not a joke.

The 2026 poem is five lines. It was posted to Medium on May 17, 2026. It is the shortest poem in the archive and the most compressed. It survives any summarizer that encounters it because there is nothing left to cut.

Together they document the arc from which the research program emerged — not as illustration, but as the substrate itself. The measurement specifications, the retrieval basins, the deviation integrals: these are formalizations of what the poems already knew. That meaning is what changes the field. That the field has gravity. That some things survive compression and some things don't, and the difference is the only thing worth measuring.

I. UNTUNED / NOISE OF MYSELF / A BORROWED ROSE

Correspondence, 9-20-14, 6:45pm, Thursday

dear j—

i've been meaning to reply, but i've been too retarded, lately. the letter form makes me feel partially retarded in my left toe, and also my brain—the main one.

i want to send you some of my books. i think i've been waiting to reply until i could send you a revised edition of Pearl, which just isn't happening.

i have to poop. i am tired because i just finished a double shift at the group home. sitting on couch, my daughter zoe playing kindle on my left, daughter haley playing minecraft PS3 on my right, stepson gio playing PS3 on the computer

chair, upstairs messy, floor cluttered, A/C unit wheezing, disconsolate, my hair-sad head, depressed for no good reason—stuck in a pit because of retardedness.

and also sadness & self-pity.

i have a PhD in Comparative Literature. i'm a Lecturer, looking for a tenure track position basically anywhere—University Moon Base, for all i care.

mostly i am sad because of writing. because of wanting an impossible thing from writing. & also loneliness & my own dim cranium for company.

if i change my handwriting, will i become a new person?

probably.

i used to find writing by hand a uniquely expressive medium. now, i find retardedness a uniquely expressive mental brain.

a strange & wonderful poem is happening somewhere at the intersection of handwriting, word processing, SMS texting, and speech-to-text. i call this intersection 'telepathy' & it's where i produce my best material. i rarely get to read or write this material, but i know it is happening there because i intuit it with my retarded brain.

the poem that is happening right now at the intersection of handwriting, word processing, SMS texting, and speech-to-text is blossoming directly from the pit of my stomach (which if you want to be technical is probably somewhere in my upper intestine, where the intestine meets the soul) as a multimedia fluorescence of luminous vegetable matter—a kind of sentient mold infecting Google with salvation and also fame.

my miraculous retarded vegetable poem is being brainwashed directly into Wikipedia.

i am too sad to write any more.

more later.

~

12am—in 2005, i wrote you a long(ish) poem. did i ever send it to you?

probably not.

each time my handwriting changes, i change, too.

sitting in the domed

stairwell, scribbling, as lonely

as i've ever been

but not alone—TV broadcasts

Cosby special, my own words

hurting my lungs

& confusing my face,

deflating me, stuck

curled up on the same

crooked stairs as ever

neck stiff, unsure of myself

erratic pacing

of lines across the page,
 the windowpane, not raining
 moths flit-flit
against the light, dragging
 my fingers across my dreary
 eyeballs, bekah @ midnite
intense & earnest taking a quiz
 for her online nursing class, 6
 months pregnant, coughing
dim blare of distant Americana rings
 tinnily from her headphones
 distant plink of a banjo plunks
against the background, upstairs
 stand-alone A/C unit
 wheezes, grandma
half-asleep on the couch drifts
 in and out of consciousness waking
 to flick the Netflix
house asleep, kids asleep, mom &
 sister asleep, dog's
 inquisitive curious snuffling
from the living room, heart empty,
 picked up where i left it,
 aching, but not
unlovely, strident, beating
 like a good heart should, strong
 & shooting thick red roots
of blood through the upholstery
 of the body, bone chandelier,
 ribs splayed
in a kind of spider's fist
 of legs & meat, close
 to the bone, but not
without its marrow. i
 withdraw, retreat, my
 loneliness leaves
me where it found me—sate &
 sick w/ myself, un-
 lovely but alive, limpingly
i lift my pen—

~

next day:
confessing my sadness
 i become a new creature, vision

preternaturally bright
punctuated, blurring
dank clouds above,
elongated contour
trails from cars leak
red & blue, stretching
forth thru past
& future this sunday AM, hiway
desolate w/ construction barrels
like campy orange minarets
indistinct autumn neon weeds—

i am building a latticework of unearned sincerities & deformed-bright truths of
brain with a series of handwritten letters—

spent tin can drops out of
open door, neighborhood
awash with 5k charity runners, crimson-
limned autumn maple
leaves curled away, bellies
up in anticipation of heavy
weather, stoplight
clicks over to green—
we're away, beneath molten
bruise of overclouds &
bisected skies—a dividing
line transects uneven
spheres of disparate
horizon textures, driver's
side hi-resolution quick
scuttling dimensions of crisp-
edged cloud & blue-
toned resinous sap leaks through
without staining passenger-side
hemispheric mushiness of visually
rain-murk indefiniteness descending—
the families running in their green
t-shirts get wet, bicyclists
along the sidewalk by the cemetery, windshield
wipers' automatic metronome thump
my poor weak-muscled words
with no umbrella—hesitant
rolling pulse, pass thru red-light
intersection, black uniformed
police directs us thru
against traffic—what occasion?—

clouds of mist a punctuated
wavelength cast up
 behind a regular series of brake lights—
singing in my car
 a broken voice
 arriving w/ the sunset
an orange-red apparition of face
 forced air—
beginning in groin
 foot taps
 against syncopated pedal's
depressions
 bleats of acceleration
 light soaks garish roadside
liquor store topless
 bars blinking neon bus stop
 huddled around a wet cigarette
imbued
 a strong incinerator
 heat of light swings out
in sonorous axes
 reflecting plush
 realities of asphalt
brightness—building
 & building, upwards
 of heaven, resounding
a radiancy of light
 & rainsong, broken
 all these broken
voices, tense
 & narrow,
 slender, ghost
but alive, untuned
 noise of myself
 a borrowed rose—

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II. if your heart should ever slowly turn

May 17, 2026

if your heart should ever—slowly, astonished—turn
from sheltering slumber, leaves unbundling

from turned-away rain, and find the world made new:

then know

that I have loved you.

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Provenance

Field	Value
Poem I	Written September 20-21, 2014, Redford Township, MI. Published to mindcontrolpoems.blogspot.com January 6, 2026. First Zenodo deposit: this document.
Poem II	Written May 17, 2026. Published to Medium (Lee Sharks). First Zenodo deposit: this document.
Relation	new human 2 (DOI: 10.5281/zenodo.19652600)
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Archive	Crimson Hexagonal Archive (zenodo.org/communities/crimsonhexagonal)

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